County Council Budget Workshop
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, April 20, 2026
9:00 AM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/382851

1. Call to Order

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 9:00 AM

Present
Chair Alice Howard
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member York Glover - @ 9:06 AM
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Lawrence McElynn
Council Member Joseph Passiment

Absent
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Gerald Dawson
Council Member Thomas Reitz

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Chair Howard led the Pledge of Allegiance.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Chair Howard stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Council Member Howard, Council Member Tabernik, Council Member Brown, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment

5. Public Comment Period

No public comments were taken.

6. Chief Financial Officer Update

a. FY 2027 Budget Preparation Update

Pinky Harriott, Chief Financial Officer, presented a presentation updating Council with the calculation of a mil, and reviewing the general fund.

7. FY 2027 Outside Agency Budget Request Presentations

a. Lowcountry Council of Governments Budget Request Presentation - Hank Amundson, Executive Director

Hank Amundson, Executive Director, presented a presentation of the LOCOG budget request. They are asking for $295,000 total.

b. Beaufort Memorial Hospital Budget Request Presentation - Russell Baxley, President & CEO

Russell Baxley, President & CEO, presented a presentation of the BMH budget request. They are asking for the same as the previous year.

c. Beaufort Jasper Hampton Comprehensive Health Services, Inc. Budget Request Presentation - Dr. Faith Polkey, CEO

Dr. Faith Polkey, CEO, presented a presentation of the BJHCHS budget request.

d. Technical College of the Lowcountry Budget Request Presentation - Mary Lee Carns, Vice President for Advancement and Workforce Development

Mary Lee Carns, Vice President for Advancement and Workforce Development, presented a presentation of the TCL budget request. They are asking for the same as last year.

e. University of South Carolina Beaufort Budget Request Presentation - Dr. Al Panu, Chancellor and Landon Jones, Vice Chancellor of Finance and Operations

Dr. Al Panu, Chancellor, and Landon Jones, Vice Chancellor of Finance and Operations, presented a presentation of the USCB budget request. They are asking for an increase from 1.1 mils to 1.4 mils.

f. Beaufort Convention and Visitors Bureau Budget Request Presentation - Robb Wells, President/CEO, Greater Beaufort Port Royal CVB

Rob Wells, President/ CEO, Greater Beaufort Port Royal CVB presented a presentation of the Beaufort Convention and Visitors budget request.

g. Hilton Head Island Chamber of Commerce Budget Request Presentation - Ariana Pernice, Vice President, Visitor & Convention Bureau, Hilton Head Island-Bluffton Chamber of Commerce

Ariana Pernice, Vice President, Visitor & Convention Bureau, Hilton Head Chamber of Commerce presented a presentation of the HHI Chamber of Commerce budget request.

8. Adjournment

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY

Alice G. Howard

BY: _____

Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:



Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: May 11, 2026